

MigAct

Safeguarding Policy

MigAct z.s.

MigAct is a community-driven organization based in Prague, committed to fostering an inclusive environment where all residents can actively participate in civic life. We create collaborative spaces, provide educational activities, and offer multilingual resources to meet the practical needs of individuals and organizations. Our work focuses on reducing barriers to full civic participation, guided by the values of cooperation, equity, responsibility, and active participation. As a diverse community of individuals, organizations, and institutions, we believe in co-creation and actively involve our supporters in shaping our development and programs.

For the purposes of this safeguarding policy, it is important to note that MigAct primarily works with adults and does not deliver direct services to children or to beneficiaries in humanitarian or care-dependent settings. While MigAct aims to operate through partnership and shared decision-making rather than hierarchical structures, we recognise that power imbalances and vulnerabilities can still arise in any organisational or community context.

Individuals may experience vulnerability due to factors such as gender, ethnicity, age, disability, migration status, or other personal circumstances. Safeguarding risks in our context may include sexual harassment, discrimination, bullying, exploitation, or other forms of misconduct or harm, whether committed by MigAct Board, members, staff, volunteers, associates, or third parties encountered through our work. This policy therefore sets out our commitment to preventing harm and to responding appropriately to any safeguarding concerns or disclosures.

This safeguarding policy applies to all activities carried out by MigAct and to all individuals engaged in or affected by our work. Its principles extend to all organisational spaces, events, communications, and workplaces, whether physical or online.

Approval & Adoption

This policy was approved by MigAct z.s. Board on April, 28th, 2026 and will be reviewed in Q2 2027.

Safeguarding Officer - Marina Puzdrova, marina@migact.net.

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Policy Statement

MigAct z.s. is committed to safeguarding the dignity, rights, and well-being of all individuals involved in its work. This includes the Board, members, staff, volunteers, and beneficiaries. We uphold a zero-tolerance approach to all forms of abuse, exploitation, harassment, discrimination, and violence.

1. Purpose

This policy aims to:

- Prevent harm to any person connected to our organization.
- Create a safe, respectful, and inclusive environment.
- Ensure that safeguarding concerns are responded to promptly and effectively.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All MigAct members, including Board members.
- All MigAct staff (full-time, part-time, and temporary).
- All volunteers, interns, and consultants.
- All participants in MigAct activities, including community members and program beneficiaries.
- Partner organisations, contractors, and service providers acting on behalf of MigAct.

Where MigAct works in partnership with other organisations, appropriate provisions will be included in partnership agreements to ensure a shared understanding of safeguarding responsibilities and a commitment to uphold MigAct's safeguarding standards.

3. Definitions

Discrimination: Unequal or prejudicial treatment based on race, gender, age, disability, religion, sexual orientation, etc.

Harassment: Unwanted behavior that causes humiliation, distress, or offense. Includes sexual harassment, which involves unwanted sexual advances or conduct.

Exploitation: Abuse of power or trust for personal gain, including sexual, economic, or labor exploitation.

Aggressive behavior: Any behavior intended to harm or intimidate another person physically, verbally, or emotionally.

Safeguarding: Measures to protect people from abuse and harm, especially vulnerable individuals.

4. Safeguarding Principles

- **Zero tolerance** for abuse, exploitation, harassment, and discrimination.
- **Do no harm:** We prioritise the safety, dignity, and well-being of all individuals involved in our work.
- **Empowerment:** We support individuals to speak up, raise concerns, and make informed decisions about their participation.
- **Accountability and transparency** in actions, decisions, and safeguarding responses.
- **Confidentiality:** Safeguarding concerns are handled with discretion and shared only on a need-to-know basis.
- **Consent and privacy in communications:** MigAct expects all members, employees and volunteers to maintain confidentiality. Personal data is protected in line with the [Personal Data Protection Directive](#) and the [Information on](#)

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[Personal Data Processing](#). Particular care is taken to safeguard the dignity and privacy of individuals who may be in vulnerable situations. Images of minors are not used without explicit consent from a parent or legal guardian, and identifying information is never shared in ways that could put individuals at risk.

5. Code of Conduct

All individuals covered by this policy (including members, staff, volunteers, and associates) must:

- Treat all people with dignity, respect, and fairness, regardless of gender, age, ethnicity, disability, sexual orientation, religion, or any other personal characteristic.
- Refrain from any form of discrimination, violence, harassment, sexual harassment, bullying, exploitation, abuse, or intimidation. This includes inappropriate comments or jokes, unwanted physical contact, coercion, misuse of organisational position or influence, and any behaviour that undermines another person's safety or dignity.
- Maintain appropriate professional and personal boundaries in all interactions related to MigAct's work, including in online communication and social media.
- Respect confidentiality and handle personal information responsibly.
- Immediately report any safeguarding concern, suspicion, or disclosure in line with MigAct's reporting procedures.

Enforcement & Disciplinary Action

Any breach of this Safeguarding Policy or Code of Conduct is considered a serious matter, which may result in disciplinary action:

- **Staff:** Failure to comply with this policy may lead to formal disciplinary action, up to and including summary dismissal for gross misconduct.
- **Volunteers & Members:** Failure to comply may result in the immediate termination of the volunteering agreement or membership.
- **External Associates:** Breaches may result in the immediate termination of contracts or partnerships.

MigAct's Board and Co-directors hold overall responsibility for embedding safeguarding principles into the organisation's culture, practices, and decision-making. They ensure that safeguarding is discussed regularly, resourced appropriately, and treated as a shared organisational responsibility.

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Allegations concerning directors or board members are handled through the same reporting and investigation procedures, with independent oversight where required.

6. Safe Recruitment & Selection

6.1. MigAct is committed to safe, fair, and merit-based recruitment and selection practices that minimise the risk of harm to staff, participants, partners, and community members. Recruitment processes are designed to ensure that all staff and volunteers are appointed based on relevant skills, experience, and alignment with MigAct's values, while integrating appropriate safeguarding precautions.

6.2. Appropriate pre-engagement checks are carried out for all members, staff and volunteers. These may include reference checks, verification of identity and qualifications, and, where relevant and legally permissible, background or criminal record checks. References include questions related to past conduct and safeguarding awareness.

6.3. Through these measures, MigAct seeks to ensure that individuals engaged in its work do not pose a risk to vulnerable persons, or colleagues.

7. Training and Awareness

7.1. All members, staff and volunteers receive a safeguarding briefing performed by the Safeguarding Officer (SO) or one of the Co-directors (SO Deputy), when they join MigAct. Everyone is required to read, understand, and confirm adherence to the Safeguarding Policy. A signed confirmation form is collected from members, staff, and volunteers and stored in their personnel file.

7.2. MigAct organises regular safeguarding refresher sessions for staff, members and volunteers at least once every two years, or more frequently where needed. Safeguarding topics may also be discussed as part of team meetings and project debriefings to promote continuous awareness.

7.3. Additional training or debriefing sessions may be arranged following serious safeguarding concerns, incidents, or investigations, to reflect on lessons learned and strengthen practice.

8. Risk Management

Workplace interactions

All members, staff and volunteers must treat each other with respect, professionalism, and dignity. Harassment, violence, bullying, discrimination, or any other form of inappropriate behaviour in the workplace will not be tolerated.

Community and field activities

MigAct undertakes a safeguarding risk assessment at the beginning of each project or activity and, where relevant, reviews risks throughout the project cycle. Special care is taken when engaging with individuals or groups who may experience heightened vulnerability. Risk assessments are proportionate to the scale and nature of the activity and are integrated into standard project planning, without requiring additional administrative procedures.

Online and digital communications

MigAct promotes safe and responsible online communication. Personal data is protected in line with data protection regulations. Photos, videos, and personal stories are shared only with informed consent. Online spaces linked to MigAct's activities are moderated to prevent cyberbullying, harassment, exploitation, or other harmful behaviour.

Responding to emerging risks

Safeguarding risks and concerns raised during activities are assessed promptly. MigAct commits to taking appropriate action to manage and reduce identified risks and to adapt practices where necessary.

9. Reporting

9.1. Any safeguarding concern, suspicion, or disclosure must be reported to MigAct's designated Safeguarding Officer.

9.2. The Safeguarding Officer is appointed by MigAct's Board for a defined term of 2 years and is responsible for receiving reports, coordinating initial assessments, and ensuring that concerns are handled in line with this policy. Contact details are shared with all members, staff, volunteers, and participants.

9.3. Concerns may be reported to the Safeguarding Officer in person or by email. An additional reporting channel is available for confidential or anonymous reporting - an online form, the link is shared with all relevant individuals.

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9.4. Reports may be made confidentially and, where appropriate, anonymously. All information is handled with discretion and shared only on a need-to-know basis.

10. Investigation and Response

10.1. All safeguarding concerns are assessed promptly by the Safeguarding Officer. Where there is an immediate risk of harm, urgent protective action is taken, including ensuring safety of affected individuals and contacting emergency services if necessary.

10.2. The Safeguarding Officer may conduct or coordinate investigations into safeguarding concerns. When the Safeguarding Officer is not available or he/she gets into a conflict of interests (e.g. is involved in the safeguarding concern or closely related to a person involved), his responsibilities are passed to one of the Co- Directors who serves as his/her Deputy.

10.3. Investigations are conducted confidentially and respectfully and are normally completed within 30 working days, unless circumstances require more time.

10.4. The investigation findings are reported to the Board, which holds final authority on all actions, including disciplinary measures or termination of engagement. To ensure impartiality, if a case involves a Board member, the investigation and final decision-making are transferred to an independent external party (such as a qualified peer from a partner organization or a legal professional).

10.5. MigAct offers appropriate support to affected individuals regardless of the outcome of an investigation, prioritizing their dignity, safety, and well-being.

10.6. Outcomes are communicated to relevant parties in a manner that respects confidentiality. All safeguarding incidents, investigations, and responses are securely documented and stored in line with data protection regulations.

11. Monitoring and Review

11.1. MigAct regularly monitors the implementation and effectiveness of this Safeguarding Policy. Responsibility for oversight lies with the designated Safeguarding Officer and the organisation's leadership.

11.2. This policy is reviewed at least once per year and additionally after any serious safeguarding incident, significant organisational change, or updates in relevant legislation or best practice standards.

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11.3. Feedback from members, staff, volunteers, participants, and partners is actively sought and considered as part of the review process. Lessons learned from reported cases, complaints, or near-miss incidents inform improvements to procedures and training.

11.4. Where appropriate, internal or external audits may be conducted to assess compliance with this policy and to identify areas for strengthening safeguarding practice.